

Hunter Ellis

(703) 953-6963 | Atlanta, GA | elliswhunter@gmail.com | github.com/hjkellis | linkedin.com/in/ellishw | hjkellis.github.io

Engineer focused on building intelligent, capable platforms. Experience in controls, motion planning, estimation, and tracking.

Experience

Avionics Research Engineer

Aug 2025 – Present

Georgia Tech Research Institute • Applied Systems Lab

Atlanta, GA

- Developing C++ software for collaborative autonomous UAV swarms in a component-based software engineering environment.
- Integrating, developing, and benchmarking sampling-based motion planning algorithms over constraint manifolds leveraging The Open Motion Planning Library (OMPL).
- Developing a containerized motion planning service with hybrid planning using graph, sampling, and optimization methods.
- Leading an independent research project developing and delivering reactive obstacle avoidance.
- Implemented multi-hypothesis tracking, including prediction and data association algorithms for multi-object tracking (MOT) in decentralized swarms using distributed camera data.
- Software systems integration
- Refactored legacy code to use DDS middleware.

Robotics Research / M.S. Computer Engineering

Aug 2023 – May 2025

Virginia Tech • Control, Optimization, and Online Learning for Autonomy Lab

Blacksburg, VA

- Built a 6-DOF robotic arm and an accompanying ROS2–Gazebo simulation environment for training, evaluating, and deploying custom control algorithms.
- Integrated object detection (YOLOv8), natural language processing, symbolic reasoning, and a DDPG-based reinforcement learning policy for robotic manipulation tasks.
- Aided professors in teaching fundamental concepts in linear systems theory and digital signal processing, including Laplace Transforms, Z-Transforms, system stability, and FIR & IIR filter design.

Thrust Vector Control Intern

May 2024 – Aug 2024

Jacobs Space Exploration Group • Thrust Vector Control Test Lab

Huntsville, AL

- Developed thrust vector control testing hardware and software for NASA's Active Inertial Load Simulator at the Marshall Space Flight Center.
- Created and ran tests to develop a mathematical model of an electro-mechanical actuator – used Python, MATLAB, and LabVIEW.

Control Research Intern

Jun 2023 – Aug 2023

G2ELab • Power Electronics Lab

Grenoble, France

- Implemented different inverter control methods for 4-leg (microgrid) topologies and tested them in Simulink and HIL.

Naval Research Enterprise Internship Program

Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

Naval Surface Warfare Center • Carderock Division

Bethesda, MD

- Developed concept hospital sea-train designs, estimated fuel consumption, and electrical power loads.

Skills

Languages: C++, Python, MATLAB/Simulink, C, Lua, $\LaTeX$

Tools & Libraries: ROS2, OMPL, DDS, Qt, Simulink, Docker, Git, FreeRTOS, SolidWorks, Autodesk Inventor (Certified)

Education

Professional Education

Jun 2026

Georgia Tech • College of Computing

Atlanta, GA

M.S. in Computer Engineering

May 2025

Virginia Tech • Bradley Department of Electrical & Computer Engineering

Blacksburg, VA

- Focus: Software and Machine Intelligence
- Research Group: Control, Optimization, and Online Learning for Autonomy Lab at UT Austin

B.S. in Electrical Engineering and Computer Engineering (Double Major)

May 2024

Virginia Tech • Bradley Department of Electrical & Computer Engineering

Blacksburg, VA

- Focus: Controls, Robotics, and Autonomy
- Design Teams: Solar Car and Human Powered Submarine